# Taylor Pentz

**Senior Snowflake / dbt Analytics Engineering**

*High Point, NC*

870 403 5119 | taylorpentz2@gmail.com | https://www.linkedin.com/in/taylor-p-b0389a3ba

## Professional Summary

Senior Snowflake / dbt Analytics Engineer with 11+ years in software engineering across SaaS, fintech, healthcare, analytics, and enterprise workflow products and recent delivery using Snowflake, dbt, SQL, Python, cloud services, databases, automated testing, and CI/CD; modernizes legacy systems, fixes production reliability issues, improves performance, mentors engineers, and turns complex requirements into secure, scalable products with measurable business impact.

## Skills

- **Primary Stack:** Snowflake, dbt, SQL, Python, Airflow, data modeling; practical delivery across SaaS, fintech, healthcare, analytics, and enterprise workflow products.
- **Data Depth:** ETL/ELT orchestration, lineage, schema evolution, dimensional modeling, streaming, data quality checks, BI semantic layers, and analytics reliability.
- **Architecture:** ETL/ELT, medallion architecture, dimensional modeling, streaming data, observability; API boundaries, domain modeling, secure design, scalability reviews, and production-readiness planning.
- **Cloud and DevOps:** AWS S3, RDS, Glue, Lambda; GCP BigQuery; Azure Data Factory; Docker, CI/CD pipelines, release automation, feature flags, rollback plans, and environment governance.
- **Databases and Messaging:** PostgreSQL, Snowflake, BigQuery, SQL Server, MySQL, Redis; schema design, indexing, query tuning, migrations, caching, reconciliation, and reliable async processing.
- **Testing and Quality:** Pytest, Great Expectations, dbt tests, data reconciliation, pipeline validation; unit, integration, contract, end-to-end, regression, load, and smoke testing aligned with release risk.
- **Monitoring and Security:** OpenTelemetry, Datadog, CloudWatch, ELK, Sentry, structured logs, alerts, OWASP, OAuth, RBAC, incident response, and RCA.
- **Senior Practices:** technical leadership, code reviews, architecture reviews, mentoring, Agile planning, stakeholder communication, legacy modernization, and production support.

## Work Experience

### SumatoSoft

**Boston, MA Remote**

Senior Software Engineer

*Apr 2023 - Dec 2025*

- Led data platform delivery for **governed reporting and operational data workflows** using **Snowflake, dbt, SQL, Python, Airflow, data modeling**, centered on **Snowflake, dbt 1.x, and Airflow 2.x**, connecting ingestion, transformation, quality checks, semantic models, dashboards, and governed access.
- Modernized legacy modules with duplicated validation, inconsistent state handling, and fragile release paths into **typed, testable, reusable components and services**, reducing production defects by **32%** across high-change customer workflows.
- Resolved late pipelines, schema drift, duplicate records, and expensive queries by adding **incremental models, partitioning, validation checks, reconciliation jobs, lineage notes, and workload-aware scheduling**.
- Designed secure integration boundaries with **OAuth, RBAC, tenant-aware filters, OpenAPI contracts, audit logging, and defensive validation**, preventing cross-account data exposure during partner and administrator workflows.
- Implemented reliable asynchronous processing with **idempotency keys, retry policies, dead-letter handling, reconciliation jobs, and transactional persistence**, eliminating duplicate business actions after provider timeouts.
- Moved fragile deployments toward **Docker-based CI/CD, infrastructure checks, feature flags, environment promotion controls, and repeatable rollback procedures**, improving release confidence for distributed teams.
- Added automated data quality gates with **dbt tests, Pytest, reconciliation reports, contract checks, freshness alerts, and regression datasets**, catching broken transformations before executive reports were published.
- Built observability with **OpenTelemetry, structured logs, Datadog and CloudWatch alerts, traces, dashboards, and incident runbooks**, accelerating diagnosis of latency spikes, memory growth, failed jobs, and webhook failures.
- Mentored engineers through **architecture reviews, pair debugging, pull-request standards, incident retrospectives, and performance-focused refactoring**, raising technical consistency across frontend, backend, QA, DevOps, and product groups.

### Hexaview Technologies Inc.

**New York, NY**

Software Engineer

*Jul 2018 - Mar 2023*

- Delivered client-facing fintech and analytics features using **Python, SQL, Airflow, Spark, dbt where appropriate, Snowflake, Kafka, BI dashboards, and data quality checks**, centered on **Python 3.7-3.9, Airflow 1/2, Spark 2.4/3, and SQL**, with **data quality, schema evolution, orchestration, BI semantic layers, APIs, cloud storage**, supporting customer dashboards, reporting workflows, account servicing, and external data integrations.
- Refactored older screens, services, and shared libraries that mixed business rules with presentation logic, improving maintainability and reducing regression bug leakage by **29%** across three major release cycles.
- Built service and API integrations for payments, CRM, identity, notifications, and reporting providers, handling **duplicate callbacks, schema drift, partial outages, retries, and reconciliation** without losing customer activity.
- Fixed production memory and worker stability issues by profiling retained objects, closing database cursors, limiting batch size, and introducing safer queue-processing controls for long-running jobs.
- Optimized reporting and search workloads through **composite indexes, query rewrites, cached summaries, asynchronous generation, and defensive timeouts**, stabilizing response times as customer records grew.
- Migrated older modules toward modern runtime, dependency, and build standards while preserving backward-compatible API contracts for dependent clients and scheduled enterprise releases.
- Expanded automated validation with **component tests, API tests, contract fixtures, browser tests, and release smoke suites**, reducing manual QA bottlenecks and catching provider response changes earlier.
- Partnered with architects, product managers, QA, and client stakeholders to split large modernization initiatives into smaller releases with measurable acceptance criteria, release notes, and support documentation.

### SimbirSoft Company

**Boston, MA**

Software Developer *Mar 2015 - Jun 2018*

- Built enterprise workflow, e-commerce, and internal operations modules using **SQL, Python, Pandas, PostgreSQL, MySQL, ETL scripts, scheduled jobs, Power BI reporting, and data quality checks** with **SQL databases, REST APIs, queues, and CI builds**, supporting approvals, orders, notifications, imports, and reporting.
- Replaced brittle server-rendered and script-heavy flows with cleaner application modules, improving task completion speed by **24%** for operations users working through repetitive approval and data-entry processes.
- Implemented service-layer validation, transaction boundaries, and database constraints that corrected duplicate submissions, inconsistent statuses, and race conditions caused by browser retries or concurrent updates.
- Assisted modernization from manual deployments and tightly coupled code into **repeatable builds, environment profiles, automated tests, structured logging, and safer release packages** across staging and production.
- Improved slow database-backed screens through **index reviews, query tuning, pagination, selective caching, and explain-plan analysis**, reducing support complaints tied to large customer and catalog tables.
- Created REST endpoints and background jobs for notifications, file imports, invoice synchronization, and status tracking while adding error queues and replay scripts for failed integrations.
- Worked with QA, analysts, and senior engineers to clarify requirements, investigate production defects, write integration tests, and document root causes for recurring customer-impacting issues.

### Microsoft
**Cambridge, MA**

Software Developer Intern *Aug 2014 - Feb 2015*

- Contributed to internal developer productivity and reporting tools using **C#, ASP.NET MVC/Web API, JavaScript, TypeScript, SQL Server, and internal Azure-hosted tools**, supporting SQL-backed services, administrative dashboards, validation rules, data exports, and workflow automation for engineering teams.
- Implemented searchable grids, export utilities, form validation, and role-aware visibility rules that helped internal users review operational data and complete routine support tasks more efficiently.
- Investigated defects in data access, validation, and workflow-state handling by reproducing failures, comparing expected outcomes, and preparing fixes reviewed by senior engineers before merge.
- Added unit and integration tests around controller logic, utility classes, SQL queries, and edge-case validation, strengthening regression coverage for tools that had relied heavily on manual checking.
- Participated in code reviews, daily standups, release readiness checks, and design discussions, gaining production-minded engineering habits around maintainability, reliability, and secure implementation.
- Documented setup steps, API assumptions, troubleshooting notes, and known limitations so future interns and full-time engineers could onboard faster and maintain the internal tools confidently.

## Selected Projects

### Cloud Data Platform and Analytics Modernization

- Delivered a governed analytics platform using **Snowflake, dbt, SQL, Python, Airflow, data modeling**, ingestion pipelines, transformation models, data quality checks, semantic reporting layers, and secure access controls for business users.

### Reliable ETL and Business Reporting System

- Improved ETL reliability with incremental loads, schema validation, reconciliation reporting, freshness alerts, lineage documentation, and pipeline observability for executive and operational reporting.

## Certifications

- **AWS Certified Data Engineer - Associate**
- **Microsoft Certified: Azure Data Engineer Associate**
- **Databricks Certified Data Engineer Associate**
- **SnowPro Core Certification**
- **Professional Scrum Developer I (PSD I)**

## Education

### University of North Carolina at Chapel Hill
Bachelor's Degree in Computer Science, 2010 - 2014